

Yongyi Lin

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RESEARCH EXPERTISE

My research examines how institutional rules and market structures shape firms' innovation strategies when appropriability over knowledge is fragile. Using quasi-experimental methods, I study how transparency mandates, intellectual property regimes, and venture capital concentration affect R&D portfolio decisions: geographic allocation, project selection, and the choice between novel and incremental innovation. Related projects on disclosure spillovers to rivals and market power in entrepreneurial finance speak to competitive strategy and how organizations adapt innovation effort under institutional constraints.

EDUCATION

University of Maryland, College Park

2021 – 2027 (expected)

Ph.D., Managerial Economics

Dissertation: Forces Shaping Innovation: Disclosure, Market Structure, and Firm R&D

Award: Clifton T. and Jane Story Phillips Scholarship

Duke University

2019 – 2021

M.A., Economics

Award: M.A. Merit Scholarship

Jinan University

2015 – 2019

B.A., Economics

Award: Outstanding Undergraduate Scholarship

WORKING PAPERS

Disclosure, Appropriability, and R&D Portfolio Choice: Evidence from the Pharmaceutical Industry

Job Market Paper | Draft

Abstract:

When rivals can use development-stage learning that patents do not protect, the private return to generating it falls. After the FDA Amendments Act of 2007 expanded disclosure requirements for U.S. clinical trials, firms with a larger pre-policy share of U.S.-targeted projects started fewer such projects, discontinued more of them, and expanded preclinical activity elsewhere. Among the U.S.-targeted projects they started, new candidates were less chemically novel, and firms shifted away from complex biologics and new technologies. These adjustments began at preclinical entry, before the trial phases the act directly regulates. Disclosure therefore changes which knowledge is produced and how novel it is, not only how existing knowledge diffuses.

Venture Capital, Market Structure, and the Financing of Innovation

with Chengmou Lei | Poster, 2026 American Finance Association Annual Meeting

Invention Ownership Legislation and Patenting

with Justin Frake, Kyeongki Park, and Evan Starr

Are There Gender Differences in Ambition? Evidence from an Online Experiment

with Nathan Barrymore and Cristian L. Dezső

PUBLICATIONS

Has Urbanization Accelerated PM_{2.5} Emissions? An Empirical Analysis with Cross-Country Data

with Qichen Dong, Jieyu Huang, and Zhongfei Chen | *China Economic Review*, 2020 | Pre-doctoral research

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

UNIVERSITY OF MARYLAND, COLLEGE PARK

BMGT392 — International Business (Instructor) Spring 2025, 2026

BUSO626 — Global Economic Environment (TA) Spring 2024

BUSI758 — Global Risks and Opportunities (TA) Spring 2022

BUSI788 — Global Business (TA) Fall 2021, 2022, 2023

DUKE UNIVERSITY

ECON601 — Microeconomic Theory (TA) Fall 2020

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

American Economic Association Annual Meeting 2026

American Finance Association Annual Meeting 2026

Wharton Corporate Strategy and Innovation Conference 2025

Academy of Management Annual Meeting 2025

Strategy Science Conference 2025

Industry Studies Association Annual Meeting 2025

Duke Strategy Ph.D. Conference 2025

East Coast Doctoral Conference 2025

METHODS AND TOOLS

Languages and tools: Python, Stata, R, SQL, LaTeX, Git, Microsoft Office

Causal and statistical methods: Difference-in-differences, event study, fixed effects, matching and inverse-probability weighting, semiparametric and double/debiased ML, survival analysis, experimental design

Machine learning and data: Deep learning (LSTM/RNN), gradient boosting, time-series forecasting, clustering and similarity analysis, record linkage and fuzzy matching

REFERENCES

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Ginger Jin

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Wilbur Chung

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